A-A-53959
18 October 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Masson, 10-1/2 inch

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-H-36873 which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers a 10-1/2 inch Masson suture needle holder, suitable for securely holding suture needles.

Salient characteristics:

General. Suture needle holders (or needle holders) shall be of the Masson design approximately 10-1/2 inches long. Needle holders shall have a box lock with a permanently secured pin or other fastening device, finger rings on the proximal end and cross cut serrated jaws with a groove on the distal end.

Material. Material of the suture needle holder shall be Class 4 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with (ASTM) Designation F899.

Style, design and dimensions. Needle holder shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 20114 for style, design and dimensions.

Hardness. Needle holders shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) of 40 to 48 when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E140.

Finish. Needle holders shall be mirror, satin or matte finish. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform nondirectional surface texture equivalent to that product by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

Passivation. Needle holders shall be properly passivated.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Corrosion-resistance. Needle holders shall show no evidence of corrosion or plating of copper when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

Performance. The joint performance of the box lock shall be smooth, of equal resistance, and non-binding when opening or closing the needle holder to an included angle of 90 degrees ± 5 degrees.

Identification marking and labeling. Needle holders shall be legibly marked with the contractor's name or trademark and the word "stainless." Foreign manufactured needle holders shall bear the name of the country of origin.

Workmanship. Needle holders shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from cracks, pits, burrs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas, corrosion, grind or tool marks, and dirt or polishing materials.

Unit. Each (EA). One holder, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one needle holder. Sampling shall be inspection level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.0.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one needle holder. Sampling shall be inspection level S-2 with an AQL of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements and as specified herein. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-341-9800	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Masson, 10-1/2 inch

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4680

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53959	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Masson, 10-1/2

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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